Interview Skills

An interview is a conversation between an employer and a prospective applicant. Interviews are of different types. Now a days, interviews are also conducted through video conferencing, through skype or over telephone.

The job interview is one of the several stages in the process of selecting the potential applicants. Listening and speaking skills play a vital role. Generally questions are asked in connection with the candidate's qualification, work experience, vision, interests, personality, physical health and general background. Apart from these, there are a number of things to remember and follow before, after and during the interview.

Before the interview

- Gather information about the organisation.
- Find out why you are interested in the organisation and the job you have applied for
- Prepare answers for standard interview questions.

Do's and Don'ts on the day of the Interview

Do's

- Be punctual. Arrive in time.
- Dress appropriately
- Act appropriately. Extend social courtesies. (Greet as you enter and thank when you leave.)
- Be positive. Stay focused.
- Maintain a confident posture.
- Maintain eye contact when you speak.
- Listen attentively. Smile pleasantly.
- Talk about your strengths.
- Ask only relevant questions.

Don'ts

- Don't be fidgety.
- Avoid sharing unnecessary information.
- Don't talk when not needed.

21st century Skills

To be successful in today's competitive world, you need to acquire necessary skills and competencies based on the field where you wish to pursue a career. Core academic knowledge and technology skills are mandatory requirements. In addition to these, regardless of the career you choose, job readiness in the 21st century requires competence in the following skill area:

- Communication skills-Aural, Oral and Written
- Critical thinking and Problem solving
- Creativity
- Collaboration and teamwork
- Initiative and leadership

While learning processes in school provide ample opportunities for holistic development, the learners need to focus on upgrading and enhancing their skills and talents through conscious continuous self driven learning.

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